Food processing

Most food for sale has undergone some sort of processing, usually to prolong its shelf life or to turn it into something more useful to the customer. Even fresh produce goes through basic processing.

WHAT IS THE OLDEST FOOD ADDITIVE?

Salt has been used for around 10,000 years as a preservative for meat and vegetables, as well as to bring out the flavor in food.

Making a lasagne ready meal

The epitome of processed food is the ready meal, where the main course and any accompanying side dishes are ready to heat and eat from a tray. Ready meals involve heavily automated production lines where the ingredients are prepared, cooked, and packed in a continuous process. Several lines are needed to create an elaborate dish, such as a lasagne.

